CODEX SOCKET RETENTION

Independent technical finding | CDX-WIN-20261017-01 | Prepared 17 Oct 2026

Finding: Persistent TCP CLOSE_WAIT socket accumulation in a signed OpenAI Codex executable; related Windows resource-leak precursor warning. **Classification:** Evidence-backed defect candidate, not a demonstrated security breach.

Quantified evidence

Signal	Measured result	Source
Snapshot	266 CLOSE_WAIT sockets, 266 unique local ports; PID 29300	Windows TCP inventory
Destinations	168 to 172.64.155.209:443; 98 to 104.18.32.47:443	TCP inventory
Independent trace	266 present at start; zero disappearance events over ~56 min	TRACE DECK events.jsonl
Windows warning	Oct 16, 9:02:25 PM EDT: event 1001, RADAR_PRE_LEAK_64, codex.exe	Windows Application log
Executable	Valid OpenAI OpCo, LLC Authenticode signature	executable_hashes.csv

Timeline (Eastern daylight time)

• Oct 16, 10:18:32 AM - codex.exe PID 29300 starts.

• Oct 16, 10:18:33 AM - oldest affected TCP socket creation timestamp.

• Oct 16, 9:02:25 PM - Windows Error Reporting flags codex.exe (RADAR_PRE_LEAK_64).

• Oct 17, 11:05:53 AM to 12:01:30 PM - TRACE DECK records 266 persistent CLOSE_WAIT sockets.

• Oct 17, 12:43:56 PM - separate collection independently snapshots all 266 sockets.

Interpretation and limits

The backlog is consistent with a socket-lifecycle cleanup problem, but no application source-level cause is established. The oldest socket was **created** more than 26 hours before capture; the records do **not** establish that it remained in CLOSE_WAIT for those full 26 hours. The independent trace does establish approximately 56 minutes of persistence in that state.

The Windows leak-precursor event independently establishes that the operating system flagged codex.exe, not that the TCP backlog caused a memory leak. This record does not show a hostile connection, exploitation, remote-control session, or data exfiltration.

Engineering follow-up requested

• Confirm whether codex.exe promptly closes sockets after remote FIN and on idle.

• Correlate socket counts with memory/handle counts and reconnect or streaming behavior.

• Run a clean restart baseline and compare before/after workload snapshots.

• Use the attached minimal exhibits for triage, then request raw logs privately if needed.